

Marketplace Platform – Founder Requirements

Version 1.0

PART 3

SECTION 11 – BOOKING SYSTEM

11.1 Request to Book

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Booking

Requirement

The platform must support a **Request to Book** system.

Guests submit a booking request which the Host must either:

- Accept
- Decline
- Allow to expire

The Host should not be able to ignore booking requests indefinitely.

11.2 Instant Booking

Priority:  Recommended

Category: Booking

Requirement

The platform should support Instant Booking as an optional setting.

Hosts should be able to decide whether:

- Every booking requires approval.
 - Eligible Guests may book instantly.
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11.3 Booking Confirmation

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Booking

Requirement

A booking must only become confirmed after all required booking conditions have been fulfilled.

Examples include:

- Host approval (where applicable)
 - Successful payment (where applicable)
 - Required guest information completed
-

11.4 Booking Reference Number

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Booking

Requirement

Every booking must receive a unique booking reference.

Public booking references must not expose sequential database IDs.

Public identifiers should use UUIDs or an equivalent secure identifier.

11.5 Booking Status

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Booking

Requirement

Bookings must support the following statuses:

- Pending
- Awaiting Host Response
- Awaiting Payment
- Confirmed
- Cancelled
- Completed
- Expired

- Refunded
 - Disputed
-

11.6 Booking Details

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Booking

Requirement

Guests and Hosts must be able to view:

- Booking reference
 - Dates
 - Number of guests
 - Property, experience or service
 - Booking status
 - Payment status
 - Cancellation policy
 - Contact options through the platform
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11.7 Booking History

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: User Account

Requirement

Guests and Hosts must be able to access current and previous bookings.

Booking history should remain available unless deletion is required by law.

11.8 Availability Calendar

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Calendar

Requirement

Hosts must be able to manage their availability using an interactive calendar.

They must be able to:

- Block dates
 - Unblock dates
 - Set minimum stay
 - Set maximum stay
 - Close dates manually
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11.9 Double Booking Protection

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Booking

Requirement

The platform must prevent two confirmed bookings for the same accommodation, experience or service during the same unavailable period.

11.10 Booking Notifications

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Notifications

Requirement

The platform must notify relevant users whenever a booking is:

- Requested
 - Confirmed
 - Declined
 - Cancelled
 - Updated
 - Completed
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SECTION 12 – PAYMENTS & TRANSACTIONS

12.1 Payment Methods

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Payments

Requirement

The platform must support:

- Secure online payment
- Payment upon arrival (where enabled by the Host)

The Administrator must be able to enable or disable available payment methods.

No payment provider should be hard-coded into the platform.

12.2 Payment Gateway

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Payments

Requirement

The platform must support one or more secure payment gateway providers.

The selected payment provider(s) must be replaceable without requiring major redevelopment.

12.3 Marketplace Payments

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Payments

Requirement

The payment solution must support marketplace transactions if the platform processes payments between Guests and Hosts.

12.4 Payment Status

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Payments

Requirement

Every booking must clearly display its payment status.

Examples include:

- Pending
 - Paid
 - Partially Paid
 - Refunded
 - Failed
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12.5 Currency Support

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Payments

Requirement

Payments must support all currencies enabled by the Administrator.

Prices should be displayed in the Guest's selected currency whenever possible.

12.6 Taxes & Fees

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Payments

Requirement

The platform must clearly separate:

- Listing price
- Cleaning fee
- Service fee
- Taxes
- Security deposit (if applicable)
- Total amount payable

Guests must see the full price before confirming a booking.

12.7 Payment Receipts

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Payments

Requirement

Guests and Hosts must be able to access payment confirmations and booking receipts from their account.

12.8 Payment Security

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Security

Requirement

The platform must never store full payment card details unless legally permitted and certified to do so.

Sensitive payment information must be handled by the selected payment provider using industry security standards.

SECTION 13 – SECURITY DEPOSITS

13.1 Security Deposit

Priority:  Recommended

Category: Payments

Requirement

Hosts should be able to require a refundable security deposit.

The Host must define:

- Deposit amount
 - Conditions for returning the deposit
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13.2 Deposit Visibility

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Booking

Requirement

Guests must clearly see the required security deposit before confirming a booking.

13.3 Deposit Return

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Payments

Requirement

Where no damage or agreed deductions exist, the security deposit should be returned according to the platform's configured process.

13.4 Deposit Disputes

Priority: ● Recommended

Category: Disputes

Requirement

Where a Host claims damage, the platform should allow supporting evidence such as photographs or documentation to be submitted before any deduction is processed.

SECTION 14 – MESSAGING

14.1 Internal Messaging

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Communication

Requirement

All communication between Guests and Hosts must take place through the platform messaging system.

14.2 Contact Information

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Privacy

Requirement

Personal contact information should not be publicly displayed.

Where platform policy requires, contact details may become available after a confirmed booking.

14.3 Message History

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Messaging

Requirement

Users must be able to view previous conversations related to their bookings.

14.4 Attachments

Priority: ● Recommended

Category: Messaging

Requirement

The messaging system should support attachments such as:

- Images
 - Documents
 - Booking-related information
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14.5 Reporting Messages

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Safety

Requirement

Users must be able to report inappropriate, abusive or fraudulent messages to the Administrator for review.

SECTION 15 – REVIEWS & RATINGS

15.1 Guest Reviews

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Reviews

Requirement

Only Guests with a completed booking may submit a review.

15.2 Host Reviews

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Reviews

Requirement

Hosts must be able to review Guests after a completed booking.

15.3 Review Eligibility

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Reviews

Requirement

Reviews must only be possible for completed bookings.

Users must not be able to review listings they have never booked.

15.4 Review Editing

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Reviews

Requirement

Once published, reviews must not be editable unless permitted under the platform's review policy.

15.5 Review Removal

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Administration

Requirement

The Administrator must be able to remove reviews that violate platform rules or applicable laws.

15.6 Overall Rating

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: Reviews

Requirement

Each listing must display an overall rating based on approved guest reviews.

SECTION 16 – USER PROFILES

16.1 Guest Profiles

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: User Accounts

Requirement

Guest profiles should include:

- Profile photo
- First name
- Verification status
- Reviews received
- Joined date

Sensitive personal information must never be publicly displayed.

16.2 Host Profiles

Priority: ● Mandatory

Category: User Accounts

Requirement

Host profiles should display:

- Profile photo

- Host description
 - Verification status
 - Listings
 - Overall rating
 - Reviews
 - Joined date
-

16.3 Company Profiles

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Companies

Requirement

Company profiles should include:

- Company name
 - Logo
 - Description
 - Verification status
 - Listings
 - Reviews
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16.4 Public Information

Priority:  Mandatory

Category: Privacy

Requirement

Public profiles must never display confidential personal information such as:

- Full residential address
 - Government-issued identity numbers
 - Passport numbers
 - Personal email addresses
 - Personal telephone numbers unless permitted by platform policy
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END OF PART 3